time, **three alternative ideas** which highlight the different roles that technology can play with respect to the environment –

1. Environmental Protection
2. Resource Management
3. Eco-Development

These alternative ideas suggest different criteria for defining green technologies. In each case, technological innovation will likely have the least impact on the environment if it is used to address problems in a holistic or systems fashion. The course of technical and industrial advancement over the last century has fundamentally transformed the relationship between human society and the natural world. As the scope and range of human activities have expanded exponentially, profound and possibly irreversible environmental changes have been set in motion.[13] For the first time in history, mankind can potentially alter the basic biophysical cycles of the earth.

The social systems which we are living in, have clearly broken away from the patterns of ecological stability that existed for almost the 2 million years when humans lived in small nomadic bands.[14] Undoubtedly, there is no turning back. While some believe that, our capacity for technical and economic progress is virtually boundless, the fact that human activities are now resulting in massive disruptions in nature is a reality. Release of elements such as mercury, nickel, arsenic, and vanadium are now several times those by natural processes. For lead, the amount released is nearly 300 times than the leed that is released by the natural processes.[15] Concentrations of carbon dioxide in the atmosphere are increasing at a rate 30 to 100 times faster than observed in the climatic record; methane concentrations are increasing 400 times faster than historically seen.[16]

Faced with the emerging environmental implications of its economic and industrial practices, societies across the world are scrutinising the role of technology in a more concerned way. We are, at times, asking some highly logical questions to ourselves , such as

- Is technology simply a vehicle for satisfying a growing list of human wants?